

<!-- chord_chart.md – exercises the “abc passthrough at a heavier workload than 05_music.md: multi-line scores, multiple voices, and dense chord-symbol annotations above each bar.

All blocks are HTML-mode only. In PDF mode the ABC fences become "[ABC music notation: ...]" literal placeholders; the prose around them still typesets cleanly so the document does not collapse. -->

Chord chart with multi-line scores

This page exercises the ‘abc passthrough at the density a working musician’s chord chart wants: chord symbols above every bar, multiple staves per piece, and – in the last example – a two-voice arrangement with a melody line and a bass line on the same staff.

A twelve-bar blues with chord changes

Twelve bars, four bars per line, with "G7", "C7", and "D7" chord symbols sitting above each downbeat. The melody is a quarter-note walking line. The trailing | 1 is the closing double bar.

```
[ABC music notation:X:1 T:Twelve-Bar Blues in G M:4/4 L:1/4 K:G &quot;G7&quot; G B d f | &quot;G7&quot; G B d f | &quot;G7&quot; G B d f | &quot;G7&quot; G B d f | &quot;C7&quot; e g b | &quot;C7&quot; e g b | &quot;C7&quot; G B d f | &quot;C7&quot; G B d f | &quot;D7&quot; A e g | &quot;C7&quot; e g b | &quot;G7&quot; G B d f | &quot;D7&quot; A e g |]
```

Once abcjsharp engraves the block in the browser, the chord symbols sit above the staff at a fixed offset (configured by abcjsharp’s `chordfont` parameter), the bars wrap to a fresh line on the engraver’s natural break-points, and each line aligns by bar rather than by absolute width.

Eight-bar phrase, two lines on the page

Some tunes – folk melodies, hymns, jazz standards – want a specific bar-per-line layout to match the verse structure. Force a break with a Lout-style line-break (\$\$\$ in ABC syntax is the explicit *score linebreak*) so each phrase ends a line.

```
[ABC music notation:X:2 T:Folk Tune in D M:3/4 L:1/4 K:D &quot;D&quot; A B c | &quot;G&quot; B A G | &quot;D&quot; A F D | &quot;A&quot; A2 z | &quot;D&quot; A B c | &quot;G&quot; d c B | &quot;D&quot; A F D | &quot;D&quot; D3 |]
```

Without the linebreak (\$\$\$ is optional; here we let abcjsharp break naturally), abcjsharp will fit as many bars per line as the container width allows. On a US Letter page with the default side-margins the engraver lays this out as two lines of four bars each.

Two-voice arrangement on one staff

A melody-and-bass arrangement using ABC’s voice tags. The lower voice (V:2) is set in stem-down notation; abcjsharp engraves both voices on the same staff, separating them by stem direction.

```
[ABC music notation:X:3 T:Two-Voice Sketch M:4/4 L:1/4 K:C V:1 &quot;C&quot; e g c | &quot;F&quot; f a f c | &quot;G&quot; d g d B | &quot;C&quot; c e g | V:2 &quot;C&quot; C, E, G, C, | &quot;F&quot; F,, A, C, F,, | &quot;G&quot; G,, D, G, B,, | &quot;C&quot; C, E, G, C, |]
```

In abcjsharp the two voices share a single five-line staff: V:1 stems point up, V:2 stems point down. The chord

symbols only need to appear on V:1 – duplicating them on the bass line would clutter the engraving.

A long-form chord chart – jazz standard

Sixteen bars, a B-section with key change implied by the chord extensions. The piece does not modulate – the key signature stays in C – but the chord changes carry the harmony forward.

The chord symbols include slash-chords ("F/C"), half-diminished ("Bm7b5"), and major-seven extensions – abcjsharp parses all the standard pop/jazz chord conventions and engraves them without further configuration. If a chord name does not parse the engraver falls back to printing the literal string above the bar.

Harp grand-staff with chord names

The fork at <https://github.com/clements/abcjsharp> supports the %%score (RH | LH) directive: two voices, brace-coupled, one staff each. Chord symbols above the RH staff only:

ABC miss intakes: N57HypSketch.Cmlout-examples.M3.W4.1.0.G1.4C=72K.C.PP.scene.RH/VLH.VRH.del-stroke.VLH.del-loss.VRH.dont.Chaout.E2.G2.2/VRH.dont.Chaout.F2.A2.2/VRH.GB.dont.D2.G2.B2/VRH.Chaout.E2.G2.2/VLH.C4.F2/C4.F2/C4.G2/C4.C2/VRH.dont.Amb.dont.A2.C2.E2/VRH.dont.Dont.D2.F2.A2/VRH.dont.G.dont.G2.B2.D2/VRH.Chaout.C2.E2.G2/VLH.A4.C2/D4.F2/G4.D2/C4.C2.

The brace at the left of the system is what `%%score (RH | LH)` buys you – without it the two voices render as two separate staves with no visual coupling.

A note on PDF mode

Every ‘abc fence above falls back to a placeholder in `-format=pdf`: the block renders as the literal `[ABC music notation: X:1 T:Twelve-Bar Blues...]`. For an archival PDF chord chart, pre-render the scores with `abcm2ps` or with the `abcmsharp` CLI, save the result as `.svg` (one file per piece), and reference them as `![twelve-bar blues] (twelve_bar.svg)` from the markdown. The HTML route stays the same; the PDF route picks up the pre-rendered images via `mdlout`’s standard image-include path.

The `abcm2ps` invocation that matches the `abcjsharp` default engraving is approximately:

```
abcm2ps -O = -q chart.abc      # writes chart.svg
```

For abcjsharp specifically:

```
abcjs render-cli chart.abc --svg --out chart.svg
```

The latter respects the `%%score`, `chordfont`, and `staffsep` parameters that the in-browser engraver uses; `abcm2ps` predates those and will reformat the brace coupling slightly differently.